

GROWTH STRATEGY CASE STUDY

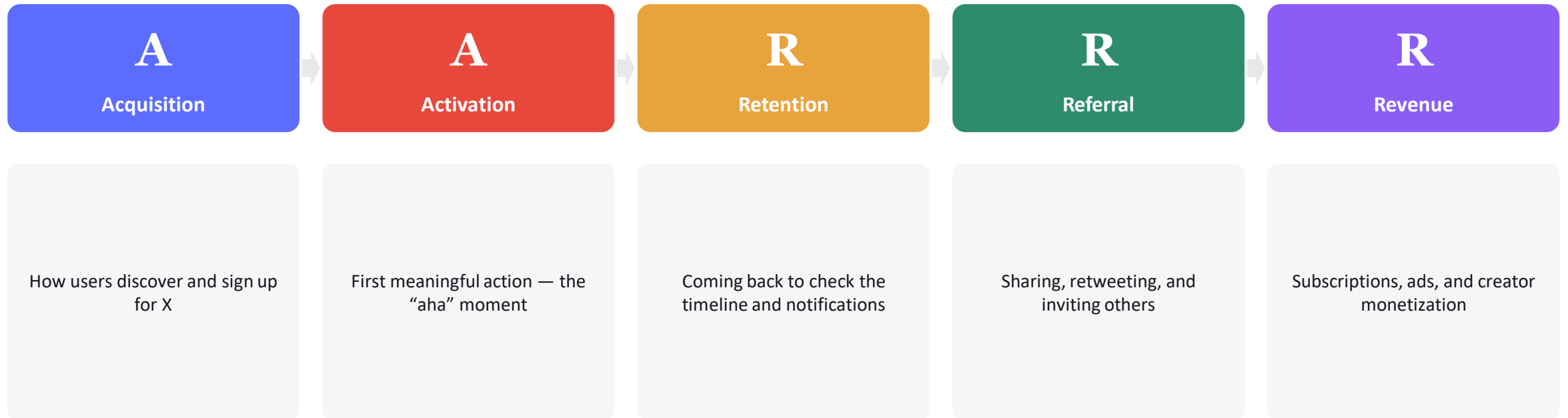
AARRR Funnel Identification & Growth Prioritization

X (formerly Twitter)

Acquisition · Activation · Retention · Referral · Revenue

The AARRR Funnel, Mapped to X

How a user moves from first exposure to long-term advocacy on the platform



Each stage below is mapped to specific X features, user behaviors, and current friction points.

AARRR Stages — Key Actions & Touchpoints on X

Stage	Key User Action	X Touchpoints / Features
Acquisition	Discovers X via search, news events, or a shared link	App Store/Play Store listing, embedded tweets on other sites, trending-topic spikes, paid ads
Activation	Completes signup, follows initial accounts, sees a relevant “For You” feed	Onboarding flow, suggested accounts/topics, interest quiz, first tweet/like/retweet
Retention	Returns daily to check timeline, notifications, and DMs	Push notifications, “For You” algorithm, Spaces, Bookmarks, streaks/habits
Referral	Shares tweets, retweets, quote-tweets, or invites contacts	Retweet/Quote Tweet, native Share sheet, embedded tweet widget, DM sharing
Revenue	Subscribes to Premium, engages with ads, or supports creators	X Premium tiers, Promoted Tweets/Ads, Creator subscriptions & ad revenue share

Where the Funnel Leaks

Friction points at each stage, and the growth opportunity each one implies

Stage	Gap	Opportunity
Acquisition	Growth has plateaued in mature markets; signup friction (phone verification) causes drop-off	Reduce signup steps; allow passkey/social login; capture spike traffic from news events with a lighter-weight preview experience
Activation	New users hit a “cold start” — an empty or irrelevant feed before they've followed enough accounts	Curated starter packs of accounts/topics based on signup context, so relevance arrives before the 3rd session
Retention	Notification fatigue and feed staleness cause drop-off after the first few weeks; many users become passive lurkers	Sharper personalization signals; re-engagement nudges tailored to lurkers vs. active posters
Referral	Most sharing happens off-platform (screenshots), which loses attribution and the viral loop entirely	Lower-friction native share/invite flows; incentivize in-app sharing over screenshotting
Revenue	Low conversion into X Premium; ad load vs. user experience remains a constant tension	Clearer, tiered value proposition for Premium; expand creator monetization to retain top accounts that drive traffic

Five Growth Epics

Each epic targets one AARRR stage's biggest gap

ACQUISITION	Frictionless Signup	Cut signup to 3 steps with passkey/social login; defer phone verification until after first session
ACTIVATION	Smart Onboarding Starter Packs	AI-curated account/topic bundles based on signup context, so the feed is relevant from session one
RETENTION	For You Feed Relevance Boost	Improve ranking signals and reduce notification fatigue with a smart digest instead of a firehose
REFERRAL	Native Sharing & Invite Loops	Low-friction in-app invite flow with an incentive for successful referrals, reducing off-platform screenshot sharing
REVENUE	Creator Monetization Expansion	Broaden subscription tiers and ad-revenue share to retain high-value creators who drive acquisition and retention

RICE Scoring

Reach (M users/quarter) × Impact (0.25–3) × Confidence (%) ÷ Effort (person-months)

Epic	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE
For You Feed Relevance Boost	15M	3	70%	6	5.25
Native Sharing & Invite Loops	10M	1.5	60%	2	4.50
Smart Onboarding Starter Packs	8M	2	80%	3	4.27
Frictionless Signup	6M	1	90%	1.5	3.60
Creator Monetization Expansion	2M	2	50%	5	0.40

RICE Score = (Reach × Impact × Confidence) ÷ Effort — higher scores indicate better expected return per unit of effort.

Prioritized Roadmap

Ranked by RICE score, highest expected return first



Note: Creator Monetization ranks lowest by RICE, but is retained on the roadmap as a strategic bet — it protects the supply side (top creators) that other epics depend on.

Summary

5

AARRR stages mapped to X-specific touchpoints

5

growth epics defined, one per stage

5.25

top RICE score — For You Feed Relevance Boost

Strategic thread

- Activation and Retention carry the biggest structural gaps — the cold-start feed problem and notification fatigue both stem from relevance, not lack of features.
- Referral is underbuilt: sharing already happens (screenshots), but X captures none of that loop's attribution or growth value today.
- RICE prioritization surfaces Feed Relevance and Native Sharing as the highest-leverage near-term bets, with Creator Monetization as a longer-horizon strategic investment.